PUNEETH RAJKUMAR

Died on Oct. 29, 2021 at age 46

The singer, actor, producer suffered a heart attack while working out at the gym





ANKUR BHATIA

Died on Jun. 4, 2021 at age 48

Executive Director of travel and hospitality conglomerate Bird Group, he died of a massive cardiac arrest

AVI BAROT

Died on Oct. 15, 2021 at age 29

The Saurashtra cricketer, a former U-19 captain, suffered a sudden cardiac arrest while watching the IPL final at his Ahmedabad residence



PANKHURI SHRIVASTAVA

Died on Dec. 24, 2021 at age 32

The founder of rental startup Grabhouse died of a sudden heart attack



for a brisk walk by the sea, regularly practises yoga," says Shivansh.

The problem with stress is that people don't know it is impacting them. "You read about it online or in the news," says Mumbai-based psychiatrist Dr Kedar Tilwe, "but you never think it could be happening to you." Doctors say that if you cannot measure stress, you can assist and manage it. The essential thing is to take time out for yourself. You don't even need to go out to do that. Today, there are online forums for meditation, therapy, social meetings and hobbies.

THE DIAGNOSTIC REVOLUTION

The silver lining, if you can call it that, to this depressing scenario is that there are enough modern diagnostic tools these days to assess one's risk factors. In addition to total cholesterol and blood sugar tests, major hospitals now also recommend tests for the inflammatory C-reactive protein (higher levels of which indicate higher risk of cardiac arrest), plasma ceramides (some of which have been linked to plaque build-up in the heart), brain natriuretic peptides (often secreted to help ease pressure on a heart when it is experiencing problems pumping), Calcium Scoring (to determine plaque build-up in the heart) and the protein troponin T (increased levels of which increase risk). Experts say these tests are far more sensitive, readily available and more affordable today. "The reason why blood tests are recommended is that you can easily take one and monitor any abnormality that may be found. We have caught heart attacks beforehand based on biomarkers found in the blood," says Dr Atul Limaye, senior interventional cardiologist at Fortis Hospital in Mulund, Mumbai.

Doctors also use a variety of other advanced diagnostic tools. The treadmill stress test and angiography remain commonly used. But these tests now have far more sensitive physiological measures that can assess blood flow,



"Being thin does not mean you are healthy. I often get patients who say they are vegetarian and then are surprised to find they have high blood pressure"

DR ANITA SAXENA
VC, Pt B.D. Sharma University, PGIMS, Rohtak